

Software Engineering Project Ethical Review

Adapted from slides by Daniel Schien

When do you need ethics approval?

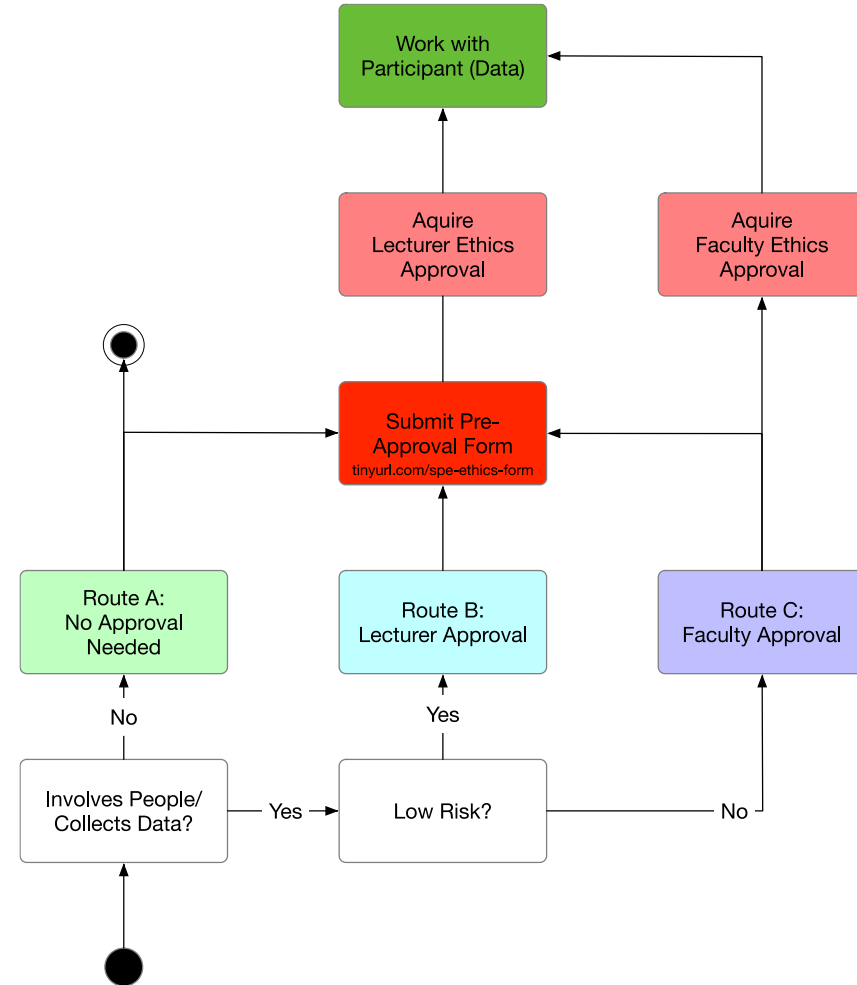
Your research or project involves people or your collecting data about people.

If your project involves asking people to **perform a task**, or if it involves **collecting any data about people**, then it needs to go through ethical review.

Sometimes a project may use data that has already been collected, but for a different purpose; this will also need to go through ethical review.

How do you get ethics approval?

- There are 3 routes: A, B and C
- Does your project involve people?
If no: Route A
If yes: Route B or C
- Submit a form to tell us
- Unsure which Route to use?
Complete the form so we can help you!



Decide Route A

No data is being collected

- This is very unlikely! We expect everyone to do some level of user testing as part of the project.
- If your team really thinks you can't do any user testing, come to the Friday drop-ins to talk to us about this
- Tell us via the ethics pre-approval form: <https://forms.office.com/e/3ZsxfecpMh>
- Follow the guidance on the last slide!

Route B – Lecturer Approval

Very straight-forward projects – participants perform a task and fill in a questionnaire

It applies

- a) if the project gathering data from adult in the UK and if the project doesn't target a vulnerable population, for example, people affected by an illness or by economic disadvantage, or people recruited from self-help groups.
- b) if the questions don't ask about racial or ethnic origin; religious or similar beliefs; membership of a trade union, physical or mental health or condition; sexual life or criminal history.
- c) if the data is anonymous at collection, that is you don't record the name or other identifying information about the subjects when you collect their data.

Route B – Lecturer Approval

- Data is anonymous at collection (this includes not videoing people so that their faces or distinguishing features are visible)
- No overt or covert observation of the participants
- Participants not tricked or deceived in any way

How to submit to Route B, Lecturer Approval

Submit an application via this pre-approval form

<https://forms.office.com/e/3ZsxfecpMh>

If you are on route B and received approval,
at **least a fortnight** before you involve participants/process user data
email [Sarah Connolly](#)

- [partipant information form](#)
- And [consent form](#)

You will need to download these and edit them with your project details

Route C – Full Faculty Ethics Review

- If your project is not covered by Routes above, described above this does not mean it cannot go ahead, but it will require ethical review by the Faculty Ethics Committee.
- This can take some time, particularly if the Committee needs to request further clarification, so you should do this as soon as possible.
- If you think you will need the Full Ethics Review, come to the Friday Drop Ins to talk about it, because projects can usually find other ways
- Your client may want you to do things that need Full Ethics – for example, testing on children – you **MUST** talk to the unit team as soon as possible

How to submit to Route C - Faculty Review

You will need to submit an ethics request form via the OREMS system. Make sure you have read all the information on this page before following the link to OREMS:

<https://www.bristol.ac.uk/students/support/academic-advice/research-ethics-review/>

The next **Faculty Ethics Review Committee deadline** is on **23rd October 2023**, so try to submit before then.

If you miss this date, you can still submit at any time, but you **MUST** get approval before you start testing.

We strongly recommend you contact the Faculty Research Ethics Administrator, Marc Moyce at marc.moyce@bristol.ac.uk, before you put in your application, to check it will all be approved. Make it very clear you are Year 2 Undergraduates!

If you have any questions about the process, want help answering the questions, or want a drop-in session to discuss the ethics review, contact Marc Moyce as above.

How to submit to Route C - Faculty Review

Tell Once you have got your us the application number via the pre-approval form: <https://forms.office.com/e/3ZsxfecpMh>

- Do this as soon as possible
- Further questions on the Faculty review process:
marc.moyce@bristol.ac.uk

Summary: What do you need to do?

- All groups submit the approval form at <https://forms.office.com/e/3ZsxfecpMh>
In your github project in the 'docs' folder create a file `ETHICS.md` with the date when the pre-approval form was submitted:
- Ethics pre-approval was applied for on <date> <time>.”
- Once you have ethics approval, add one of these options to your ETHICS.md file
 - 1) Route A: "No personal data is collected as part of this project."
 - 2) Route B: "An ethics approval for this project was given by Dan Schien"
 - 3) Route C: "Research ethics were reviewed by the Faculty of Engineering ethics committee in application **SUPPLY NUMBER**."